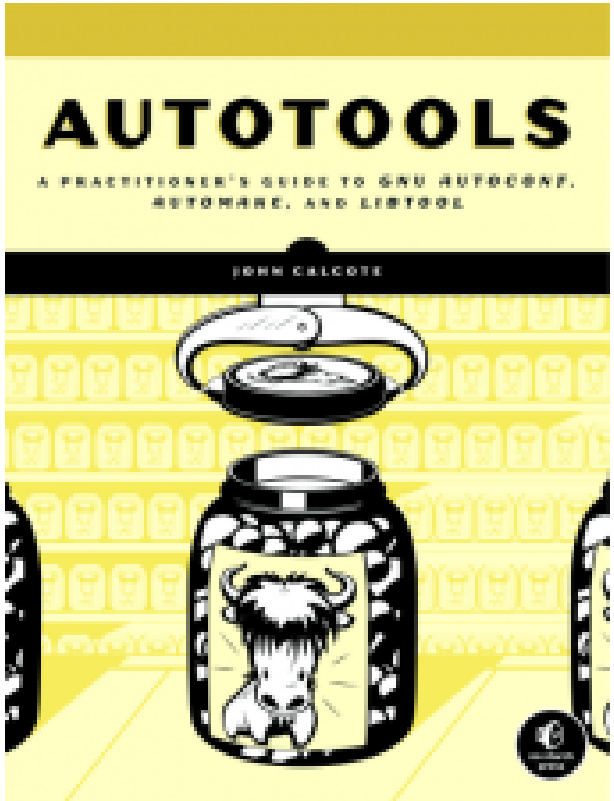
Autotools references

Existing code

- Lots of open-source projects are using the *autotools*
- They provide a lot of examples on how to configure and build things using the *autotools*
- However, make sure to have a critical eye when reading existing *autotools* code
  - For a lot of developers, the build system part is not their primary knowledge and interest
  - Lots of projects use deprecated constructs or truely horrible solutions
  - Don't copy/paste without thinking!

Book: *Autotools, a practitioner's guide*

- **Autotools, A Practitioner's Guide to GNU Autoconf, Automake, and Libtool**
- John Calcote
- No Starch Press
- https://www.nostarch.com/autotools.htm
- Excellent book.



Official documentation

- The official reference documentation from GNU is also very good, once you have a good understanding of the basics.
- Autoconf https://www.gnu.org/software/autoconf/manual/
- Automake https://www.gnu.org/software/automake/manual/
- Libtool https://www.gnu.org/software/libtool/manual/

GNU Operating System

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GNU Automake

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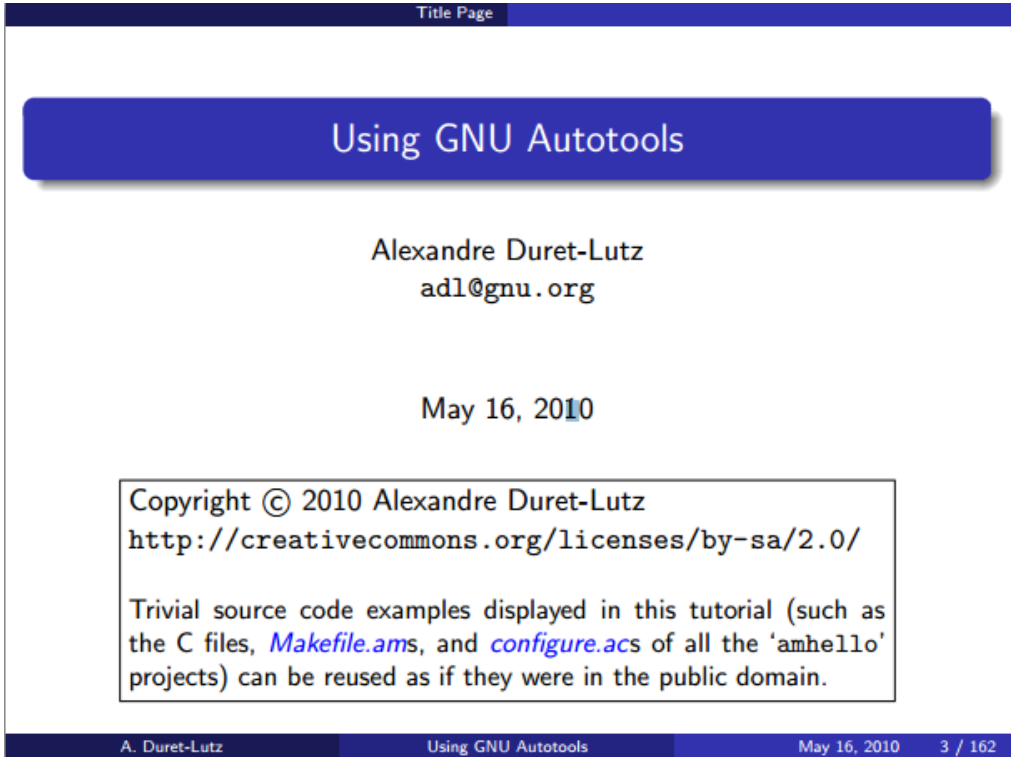
last updated January 05, 2015

This manual (automake) is available in the following formats:

- HTML (1012K bytes) - entirely on one web page.
- HTML - with one web page per node.
- HTML compressed (208K gzipped characters) - entirely on one web page.
- HTML compressed (264K gzipped tar file) - with one web page per node.
- Info document (168K bytes gzipped tar file).
- ASCII text (580K bytes).
- ASCII text compressed (156K bytes gzipped).
- TeX dvi file (260K bytes gzipped).
- PDF file (868K bytes).
- Texinfo source (152K bytes gzipped tar file).

Tutorials

- **Autotools tutorial**, Alexandre Duret-Lutz, https://www.lrde.epita.fr/~adl/autotools.html
- **Autotools Mythbuster**, Diego Elio "Flameeyes" Pettenò, https://autotools.io/
- **Introduction to the Autotools**, David Wheeler, including a video, https://www.dwheeler.com/autotools/



Title Page

Using GNU Autotools

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May 16, 2010

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Trivial source code examples displayed in this tutorial (such as the C files, *Makefile.am*s, and *configure.ac*s of all the 'amhello' projects) can be reused as if they were in the public domain.

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Use up to date materials

- Be careful to use up-to-date material
  - For example, the well-known book *GNU Autoconf, Automake and Libtool"* by Gary Vaughan et al., published originally in 2000 is completely out of date
  - Even though *autotools* are old, they have evolved quite significantly in recent times!